

Dichen Li

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Education

University of California, San Diego

09/2024-03/2026

Master's Program in ECE department: Major in EC80 intelligent system & robotics | GPA: 3.96/4.00

University of California, Berkeley

09/2023-06/2024

Exchange Program: Studying in EECS department

Relevant Curriculum: Designing, Visualizing and Understanding Deep Neural Networks; Introduction to Artificial Intelligence

Xi'an Jiaotong University

09/2020-06/2024

Bachelor of Engineering: Major in Automation (Graduate with honor) | GPA: 3.92/4.30 rank: 19/220

Publications

“Towards Embodiment Scaling Laws in Robot Locomotion.”

CoRL2025

Bo Ai*, Liu Dai*, Nico Bohlinger*, Dichen Li*, Tongzhou Mu, Zhanxin Wu, K. Fay, Henrik I. Christensen, Jan Peters, Hao Su.

“Versatile Locomotion Skills for Hexapod Robots.”

IROS2024

Tomson Qu, Dichen Li, Avidesh Zakhori, Wenhao Yu, Tingnan Zhang.

Awards

1st Prize of Shanxi Province, China in the 2022 National College Student Mathematical Modeling Competition

Research Experiences

Embodiment Adaptation in Locomotion

04/2025-Present

Graduate Research Intern | UC San Diego

- Trained the locomotion controller online to learn diverse gaits across a continuous range of robot embodiments with varying robot parameters.
- Designed and trained a transformer-based adaptation module to infer unknown robot parameters from historical trajectories, enabling robustness to motor failures, payload variations and other uncertainties, improving generalization across diverse embodiments.

Large-scale Embodiment Scaling Law Discovery

10/2024-05/2025

Graduate Research Intern | UC San Diego

- Conducted reinforcement learning of locomotion policies on 1,000 distinct robots (hexapod, humanoid and quadruped; with different topology, geometry and kinematic features) using Isaac Lab.
- Conducted large-scale supervised teacher-student policy distillation, and achieved real-world deployment for both teacher and student policies on Unitree Go2 and H1 robot.
- Discovered that training on accumulated embodiment improves performance, and that embodiment scaling outperforms data scaling.
- Paper accepted to CoRL 2025 as the 4th co-author.** The corresponding author is Professor Hao Su.
- Paper title: Towards Embodiment Scaling Laws in Robot Locomotion.**

Hexapod Robot Manipulation with Reinforcement Learning

09/2023-05/2024

Undergraduate Research Intern | UC Berkeley

- Designed reward and trained reinforcement learning policies in complex environments for a hexapod robot with depth-sensing cameras to accomplish tasks of obstacle avoidance, stair climbing, and narrow passage traversal.
- Conducted policy distillation with the only viable observations, and deployed on real hexapod robots, achieving stair climbing, cave-like passages traversal (height reduction from 22cm to 10cm), and obstacle avoidance (maneuvering around 40x40x40cm blocks).
- Paper accepted to IROS 2024 as the 2nd author.** The corresponding author is Professor Avidesh Zakhori.
- Paper title: Versatile Locomotion Skills for Hexapod Robots.**

Four-Wing UAV Control and Navigation

04/2022-08/2023

Undergraduate Research Assistant | Xi'an Jiaotong University

- Developed real-time flight control firmware in C/Keil (TM4C) with multi-level PID and mission logic.
- Adapted ROS system files for sensor data management and utilized hector_mapping for UAV indoor localization. Developed a real-time object detection system using Python, PyTorch, and OpenCV using the YOLOv5 model.

Skills

- Reinforcement learning for robotic locomotion.
- Deployment of control policies on physical robots with embedded systems, sensors and actuators.